ENGLISH - A PINCH OF SNUFF

Chapter 3 | Objective Questions | Class 12 | Test Date: 2026-10-23 | Maximum Marks: 100 (1 mark each) | Maximum Time: 120 minutes

Section A — Objective Questions (MCQs)

1. Nanukaka was coming to Delhi to _____ (Choose the correct option)
(A) see some people (B) see some minister
(C) see his sister (D) see some relatives

2. Who travelled free with Nanukaka ?
(A) Dog (B) Rabbit (C) Hen (D) Kitten

3. The narrator in "A Pinch of Snuff" was a/an _____ on probation.
(A) Secretary (B) Clerk
(C) Under-Secretary (D) Bank Officer

4. For what purpose had Nanukaka come to Delhi ?
(A) For paying the debt (B) Attend Zamindar convention
(C) To take rest (D) To see some Minister

5. Manohar Malgaonkar's story is full of wit and_____
(A) Humour (B) Tragedy (C) Adventure (D) Irony

6. "Nanukaka opened his silver snuffbox and took a _____ "
(A) coat (B) kurta (C) pinch (D) pitch

7. Nanukaka went to visit the _____ Minister.
(A) Finance (B) Welfare (C) Railway (D) Home

8. Nanukaka managed to travel in 2nd class on a _____ ticket.
(A) 1st class (B) General class (C) 3rd class (D) Sleeper class

9. Nanukaka went to the _____ Auto Dealers.
(A) Sikka (B) Alankar (C) Rikka (D) Kia

10. The chapter introduction describes Manohar Malgaonkar as a:
(A) poet and playwright (B) historian and critic
(C) journalist and painter (D) novelist and short story writer

11. In which year was Manohar Malgaonkar born, according to the introduction?
(A) 1903 (B) 1913 (C) 1923 (D) 1931

12. How many publications does the introduction say Malgaonkar had to his credit?
(A) Fewer than 10 (B) Over 25 (C) Exactly 12 (D) About 5

13. A Pinch of Snuff is taken from which collection?
(A) Distant Drum
(B) The Princes
(C) A Bend in the Ganges
(D) Contemporary Indian Short Stories in English

14. Which of the following is listed as one of Malgaonkar's important works?
(A) The Tiger King (B) Bombay Beware
(C) The Last Lesson (D) Lost Spring

15. The introduction praises the story's narrative for its accuracy and profound:
(A) sorrow (B) comedy (C) mystery (D) romance

16. What announcement from Mother disturbed the narrator?
(A) Ratiram was leaving Delhi (B) A minister was visiting
(C) Nanukaka was coming (D) The narrator was being transferred

17. What did the narrator suggest sending Nanukaka by wire?
(A) That the minister was unavailable
(B) That the kitten was missing
(C) That the family was leaving or he had been transferred
(D) That the train was cancelled

18. How long did Nanukaka say he could stay?
(A) A week or two (B) Two or three days
(C) One month (D) Only one night

19. Why was the narrator uneasy about Nanukaka's visit?
(A) He disliked the kitten
(B) He had no place to stay in Delhi
(C) He expected a ministerial visit to take a long time to arrange
(D) He had to travel abroad

20. What did the narrator fear was more than his job's worth?
(A) Asking a Minister for an interview appointment
(B) Taking two days off work
(C) Driving to the North Block
(D) Looking after the kitten

21. In the narrator's view, how far above God were Ministers?
(A) One step (B) Three steps
(C) They were not above God (D) Two steps

22. What was Nanukaka's relationship to Mother?
(A) Her father (B) Her cousin (C) Her son (D) Her brother

23. What did Nanukaka wear over his shoulders?
(A) A white angocha (B) A black shawl
(C) A red scarf (D) A yellow coat

24. What kind of coat did Nanukaka wear at the station?
(A) An old-fashioned knee-length black coat
(B) A short white coat
(C) A close-collar blue coat
(D) A long orange coat

25. What did Nanukaka wear on his head when he arrived?
(A) A white cap (B) A red silk pugree
(C) A black turban (D) A yellow scarf

26. What did Nanukaka hand the narrator at the station?
(A) A basket (B) A suitcase (C) A letter (D) A snuffbox

27. What was inside the basket?
(A) A puppy (B) A hen (C) A kitten (D) A rabbit

28. With which group did the narrator pass through the station gate?
(A) A school group (B) A Sikh marriage party
(C) A group of soldiers (D) A party of zamindars

29. Who escorted Nanukaka from the station yard?
(A) A Deputy-Secretary (B) A chauffeur
(C) A ticket inspector (D) A minister

30. Why did the narrator duck and run through the station?
(A) A train guard had called him
(B) The kitten's protests from the basket had drawn attention
(C) He had missed the last tonga
(D) Nanukaka had asked him to fetch the car

31. What did Nanukaka say about the ticket inspector who escorted him?
(A) He refused to issue any ticket (B) He had travelled with Nanukaka
(C) He was a nice young man (D) He asked the narrator for a job

32. What did the narrator say about the kitten when Nanukaka asked how it was?
(A) It was very quiet (B) It was hungry
(C) It had escaped (D) It was asleep on Mother's lap

33. What had the last tonga done by the time Nanukaka came out?
(A) It had returned (B) It was waiting at the platform
(C) It had gone (D) It had taken the kitten away

34. Where did Mother put Nanukaka?
(A) In the narrator's bedroom (B) In the back verandah
(C) In the kitchen (D) In the guest room at the station

35. Where did the narrator sleep while Nanukaka stayed?
(A) On a charpoy in the back verandah (B) On the floor in the kitchen
(C) In the car (D) At the North Block

36. How much leave did the narrator take from the office?
(A) One day (B) Three days (C) Two days (D) A week

37. Where did the narrator drive Nanukaka for the first ministerial visit?
(A) The railway station (B) Sikka Auto Dealers
(C) Lala Sohanlal's house (D) The North Block

38. How long did Nanukaka spend being passed from one chaprasi to another?
(A) One hour (B) Two hours (C) Three hours (D) Half an hour

39. What appointment did Nanukaka finally get?
(A) An immediate meeting with the Minister
(B) An appointment with a Deputy-Secretary three days later
(C) A meeting with Ratiram that evening
(D) An appointment with Sohanlal the next week

40. In which language did Nanukaka use swearwords when angry?
(A) Hindi (B) English (C) Punjabi (D) Marathi

41. What kind of car flashed past the narrator and Nanukaka?
(A) A black taxi (B) A white train carriage
(C) A yellow sports car (D) A red tonga

42. Where did Ratiram work?
(A) At Sikka Auto Dealers
(B) In the North Block ticket office
(C) In the same Ministry as the narrator
(D) At the Zamindars' Convention

43. Who was Ratiram's father?
(A) Lala Sohanlal Ratiram (B) Hajrat Barkat Ali
(C) The Welfare Minister (D) Maharaja Sutkatta

44. According to the narrator, what did getting a foreign assignment require?
(A) A train reservation (B) Pull
(C) A minister's written exam (D) A zamindar's title

45. What role did Nanukaka ask the narrator to play at Sohanlal's house?
(A) A ticket inspector (B) A Deputy-Secretary
(C) An astrologer's assistant (D) A sort of A.D.C.

46. What did the narrator wear to accompany Nanukaka to Sohanlal's house?
(A) A Jodhpur coat and an orange turban (B) A black coat and red pugree
(C) A white uniform and cap (D) A suit and a red scarf

47. What did Nanukaka claim had brought him to Delhi when speaking to Sohanlal's secretary?
(A) A car exhibition (B) A meeting of ticket inspectors
(C) A family wedding (D) A Zamindars' Convention

48. Who had supposedly sent Nanukaka a cable and wanted to see him?
(A) Ratiram (B) V.P.
(C) The narrator (D) The ticket inspector

49. Where did Nanukaka claim he had been on Sunday?
(A) Washington (B) Beirut (C) Geneva (D) Bombay

50. What did Nanukaka call Hajrat Barkat Ali?
(A) Old H.B. (B) Lala ji (C) Sutkatta (D) V.P.

51. What position did Hajrat Barkat Ali hold?
(A) Ambassador (B) Welfare Minister
(C) Party Boss (D) Deputy-Secretary

52. How did Nanukaka say he knew Hajrat Barkat Ali?
(A) They were brothers (B) They had been at school together
(C) They worked at Sikka Auto Dealers (D) They had met at the railway station

53. What job had Sohanlal's son been due to take?
(A) Ticket inspector at the station
(B) Deputy-Secretary in North Block
(C) Hereditary astrologer to Ninnore
(D) Trade Commissioner to Hajrat Barkat Ali

54. What matter had allegedly harmed Sohanlal's son's prospects?
(A) A transaction concerning evacuee property
(B) A dispute over the kitten
(C) A failed train reservation
(D) A disagreement about the car

55. What did Nanukaka promise to do for Sohanlal?
(A) Arrange a meeting with Ratiram (B) Buy the yellow sports car
(C) Write to Hajrat Barkat Ali (D) Ask the narrator to resign

56. Before discussing business, what topics did Nanukaka and Sohanlal talk about?
(A) Kittens, trains and snuff (B) Zamindars, votes and the weather
(C) Cars, coats and turban styles (D) Books, schools and holidays

57. When Sohanlal asked whether Nanukaka knew him, what did Nanukaka reply?
(A) They had been at school together (B) Of course not.
(C) They were close relatives (D) They had met at the railway station

58. What did Nanukaka casually mention while taking snuff at Sohanlal's house?
(A) The ticket inspector's name (B) The narrator's mother's name
(C) The Sikka dealer's name (D) The Welfare Minister's name

59. How did Sohanlal and the Welfare Minister get along?
(A) They were close friends (B) They had never met
(C) They were at daggers drawn (D) They were business partners

60. Why had the Minister and Sohanlal fallen out?
(A) The Minister refused to consider Sohanlal's son's marriage to his daughter
(B) Sohanlal refused to sell him a car
(C) The Minister rejected his Zamindars' Convention
(D) Sohanlal refused to lend him a snuffbox

61. What did the Minister want for his daughter, according to Sohanlal?
(A) A Trade Commissioner (B) A prince
(C) A ticket inspector (D) A zamindar's secretary

62. Which place was named as the prince's state?
(A) Beirut (B) Geneva (C) Washington (D) Ninnore

63. What had not yet been exchanged by the two families?
(A) Letters of appointment (B) Train tickets
(C) Car keys (D) Horoscopes

64. How did Sohanlal and his secretary see Nanukaka off?
(A) They bowed to him from the porch (B) They followed him to the station
(C) They handed him a letter (D) They refused to say goodbye

65. What type of car did Nanukaka want for the next visit?
(A) A small taxi
(B) A large private car with a liveried chauffeur
(C) A yellow sports car driven by Ratiram
(D) A tonga with a ticket inspector

66. Who was to act as the chauffeur?
(A) The narrator (B) The dhobi
(C) Sohanlal's secretary (D) The ticket inspector

67. What was the value of the cheque Nanukaka placed in his old coat?
(A) Two rupees (B) One hundred rupees
(C) Ten thousand rupees (D) One thousand rupees

68. Who brought the coat and cheque to the auto dealers?
(A) The Minister (B) Ratiram (C) The dhobi (D) The secretary

69. What reward did Nanukaka give the dhobi?
(A) A thousand-rupee cheque (B) A two-rupee note
(C) A new coat (D) A train ticket

70. What did Nanukaka say about the bearer cheque when the dhobi returned it?
(A) It had already been paid (B) It was only a receipt
(C) It did not belong to him (D) Anyone could have cashed it

71. How was the large car described?
(A) As if made for a railway platform (B) As if built for a sports race
(C) As if built for a court procession (D) As if designed for a school parade

72. What did Nanukaka ask for at the Minister's residence?
(A) The visitors' book (B) A train timetable
(C) A cheque book (D) A Zamindars' Convention list

73. What title did Nanukaka write after his name in the visitors' book?
(A) Hereditary Astrologer to the Maharaja of Ninnore
(B) Under-Secretary to the Welfare Minister
(C) Trade Commissioner to Hajrat Barkat Ali
(D) Ticket Inspector at North Block

74. What reason did Nanukaka give for making a formal call?
(A) He had lost his train ticket
(B) He wanted to return a car
(C) He had come to deliver a kitten
(D) It was a courtesy observed by people from old princely states

75. Where did Nanukaka loudly say he had to go next?
(A) The station yard (B) Maharaja Sutkatta's palace
(C) Sikka Auto Dealers (D) The Zamindars' Convention

76. What did Nanukaka say he had to return to the Maharaja?
(A) Horoscopes (B) A silver snuffbox
(C) A thousand-rupee cheque (D) A kitten

77. What did the narrator see looking at them from an upper-story window?
(A) A ticket inspector with a basket (B) A man in an orange turban
(C) A kitten on a charpoy (D) A large dark, khaddar-clad figure

78. What were the family trying to do with the new kitten when the car arrived?
(A) Teach it to travel by train (B) Give it to the dhobi
(C) Take it to Sohanlal (D) House-break it

79. What had the narrator never found out?
(A) Where the kitten came from
(B) What Nanukaka wanted to see the Minister about
(C) Who owned the yellow sports car
(D) How the narrator got his leave

80. How far from Ninnore had Nanukaka ever been, according to the narrator?
(A) He had lived there for years
(B) He had visited it the previous week
(C) He had travelled there by train
(D) He had never been within a hundred miles of it

81. Where did the narrator wish to be when the Minister discovered the truth about Ninnore?
(A) Somewhere far out of range (B) At the Minister's office
(C) At Sikka Auto Dealers (D) At the railway platform

82. Which word in the glossary means "oily, greasy"?
(A) fawning (B) chirpy (C) auspicious (D) legitimate

83. In the story, Nanukaka puckers his eyebrows as if in deep thought. The glossary gives "puckering" as:
(A) waving about (B) knitting together
(C) strolling slowly (D) speaking loudly

84. What does "wreathed" mean in the glossary?
(A) transferred (B) reserved (C) adorned (D) departed

85. The glossary defines "tramping" as:
(A) marching or slogging (B) whispering or murmuring
(C) laughing or smiling (D) waiting or resting

86. What does the glossary say "expletives" means?
(A) sweetmeats (B) formal greetings
(C) bad language (D) foreign assignments

87. In the glossary, "garnish" is explained as:
(A) pretty (B) unusual (C) favourable (D) lawful

88. The glossary gives "convention" as a:
(A) ticket or reservation (B) coat or turban
(C) conference or meeting (D) promise or reward

89. If a speaker "trailed off," the speaker:
(A) became louder and angrier (B) started running quickly
(C) changed the subject at once (D) grew faint or weakened

90. The glossary meaning of "ingratiating" is:
(A) marching (B) careless (C) unusual (D) flattering

91. Which suffix completes the noun formed from "arrange" in the chapter's word-formation exercise?
(A) -ment (B) -ness (C) -ful (D) -ist

92. Which noun is formed from "impress" in the chapter's word-formation exercise?
(A) impressive (B) impression (C) impressing (D) impressful

93. Which is the correct tag question for "It is amazing" as used in the lesson?
(A) doesn't it? (B) wasn't it? (C) aren't they? (D) isn't it?

94. In the phrase "try out the car," what does "try out" mean?
(A) test (B) return (C) repair (D) hide

95. In the story, "at daggers drawn" describes people who are:
(A) celebrating together (B) travelling together
(C) quarrelling (D) meeting for the first time

96. In the glossary, "liveried" means:
(A) unusually large (B) favourable
(C) careless (D) uniformed

97. What does the glossary say "outlandish" means?
(A) lawful and fair (B) cheerful and happy
(C) extremely strange and unusual (D) polite and flattering

98. Which meaning does the glossary give for "blandly"?
(A) quickly (B) angrily (C) unexcitingly (D) carefully

99. A person described as a "stickler" is a:
(A) ticket seller (B) foreign visitor
(C) story writer (D) perfectionist or hard taskmaster

100. What does "auspicious" mean in the chapter glossary?
(A) strange and unusual (B) careless or foolish
(C) favourable or promising (D) oily or greasy